



Species

ISSUE 65

2024-2025 Report of the IUCN Species Survival Commission and Secretariat



The IUCN Species Survival Commission (SSC)

The IUCN Species Survival Commission (SSC) is a science-based network of thousands of volunteer experts from almost every country of the world, all working together toward achieving the vision of “a just world that values and conserves nature through positive action to both prevent the loss and aid recovery of the diversity of life on earth.”

Members of SSC belong to one or more of near 200 Specialist Groups, Red List Authorities, Action Partnerships, Task Forces, and Conservation Committees that make up the Network, each focusing on a taxonomic group (plants, fungi, mammals, birds, reptiles, amphibians, fishes, and invertebrates), national species, or a disciplinary issue, such as sustainable use and livelihoods, translocation of species, wildlife health, climate change, and conservation planning.

Framed by the Species Conservation Cycle, SSC's major role is to provide information to IUCN on biodiversity conservation, the inherent value of species, their role in ecosystem health and functioning, the provision of ecosystem services, and their support to human livelihoods. This information is fed into the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species.

2021-2025 Species Strategic Plan

The IUCN Species Strategic Plan encompasses the joint work of the IUCN Species Survival Commission and a number of partnerships to achieve more than 2,700 targets proposed by the Network during the 2021-2025 quadrennium.

To accomplish those targets, the Species Conservation Cycle was established, which is the conceptual framework for the Network activities. The Species Conservation Cycle's main purpose is to guide efforts for valuing and conserving biodiversity through three essential components that are linked to each other:

ASSESS: Understand and inform the world about the status and trends of biodiversity.

PLAN: Develop collaborative, inclusive and science-based conservation strategies, plans and policies.

ACT: Convene and mobilise conservation actions to improve the status of biodiversity.



Their implementation requires two transversal components:

NETWORK: Enhance and support our immediate network and alliances to achieve our biodiversity targets.

COMMUNICATE: Drive strategic and targeted communications to enhance our conservation impact.

SSC Species Report

Annual progress in the implementation of the 2021-2025 Species Strategic Plan is documented in the SSC *Species Report*, which consists of a comprehensive description and analysis of the activities and results generated by the members of the SSC Network and Centers for Species Survival (CSS) each year. Each SSC and CSS group contributes to this document by providing a yearly summarised description of their achievements, which is presented in stand-alone reports.

Structure of the IUCN SSC and CSS Stand-alone Reports

Stand-alone reports summarize the activities conducted and results generated by each group member of the SSC and CSS. Following, is the structure of the stand-alone report and the contents under each session.

Title of the group

Photograph(s) of the Chair/Co-Chairs

Group information

Includes names of Chair/Co-Chairs, Vice-Chairs, Deputy Chairs, Red List Authority Coordinators, Program Officers, Species Survival Directors, and Species Survival Officers, their institutional affiliations, number of members and social networks currently active.

Logo of the group

Mission statement

Includes the mission of the group.

Projected impact for the 2021-2025 quadrennium

Includes the description of the impact on species conservation resulting from the implementation of the targets formulated by the group for the 2021-2025 quadrennium.

Targets for the 2021-2025 quadrennium

Includes the targets planned by the SSC or CSS group for the 2021-2025 quadrennium ordered alphabetically by component of the Species Conservation Cycle. Each target is labeled with a numerical code (e.g., T-001, T-012) that identifies it in the SSC DATA database and its status for the reported year is indicated (Not initiated, On track or Achieved).

Activities and results

Includes the targets for which activities were conducted and results that were generated during 2024 (full year) and 2025 (first quarter), ordered alphabetically, first by component of the Species Conservation Cycle, and second by Activity Category. Description of activities and results includes the indicator that best describes progress, its associated quantitative or qualitative result, and the narrative description of the activity conducted or result obtained. Each activity or result reported is linked to the Key Species Result to which it is mainly associated (e.g., KSR#1, KSR#5).

Acknowledgements

Includes the acknowledgements to funding agencies, partners, and persons who contributed to the progress of the targets of the group.

Summary of achievements

Summarises information of the group’s strategic plan for the quadrennium and progress achieved implementing targets for all the components of the Species Conservation Cycle during the reported year.

Example for the recommended citation:

Mittermeier, R. (2025). 2024-2025 Report of the Primate Specialist Group. In: IUCN SSC and Secretariat. *Species: Annual Report of the IUCN Species Survival Commission and Secretariat 2024-2025*. Gland, Switzerland: IUCN. 12 pp.,

Animalia

Fungi

Plantae

National Species

Disciplinary

Action Partnership

Task Force

Red List Authority

Committee

Center for Species Survival

2024-2025 Report

IUCN SSC Primate Specialist Group



CHAIR
Russell A. Mittermeier
Re:wild, Austin,
Texas, US



DEPUTY CHAIR
Anthony Rylands
Re:wild, Austin,
Texas, US



DEPUTY CHAIR
Kim Reuter
Lemur Love, San
Diego, California, US



DEPUTY CHAIR
Andie Ang
Mandai Nature,
Singapore

SOCIAL MEDIA AND WEBSITES
Website: www.primate-sg.org



DEPUTY CHAIR
Christoph Schwitzer
Dublin Zoo, Ireland



DEPUTY CHAIR
Leandro Jerusalinsky
Instituto Chico
Mendes de Conser-
vação da
Biodiversidade
(ICMBio), Brazil



**RED LIST AUTHORITY
COORDINATORS**
Christoph Schwitzer
Dublin Zoo, Ireland
Sanjay Molur
Zoo Outreach
Organisation,
Coimbatore, India

**RED LIST AUTHORITY
COORDINATORS**
Liz Williamson (Apes)
University of Stirling,
Stirling, Scotland, UK
Kim Reuter
Lemur Love, San
Diego, California, US

NUMBER OF MEMBERS
800

Mission statement

The mission of the Primate Specialist Group (PSG) is to maintain the current diversity of the order Primates by ensuring the survival of threatened species wherever they occur and providing effective protection for large numbers of primates in areas of high primate diversity and abundance. In essence, the PSG has a Zero Extinction policy for all primate species.

Projected impact 2021–2025

A significant impact on currently saving 527 species – 717 species and subspecies – of primates from extinction.

Targets 2021–2025

ASSESS

T-005 Complete all Red List assessments for primates and put in place a new rolling system for individual species assessments as new data become available.
Status: On track

T-006 Maintain a taxonomic, geographic and conservation status (Red List) database for primates.
Status: On track

T-007 Publish articles on the taxonomy, geographic distributions, surveys and conservation status of primates.
Status: Achieved

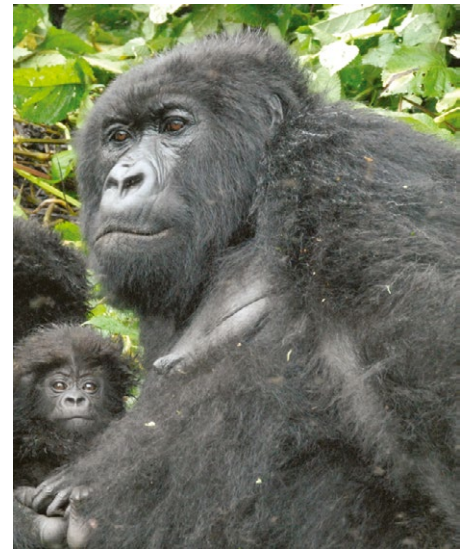
PLAN

T-028 Prepare action plans for the conservation of primate species and species

groups, including: (1) the Red Colobus Action Plan; (2) the Mangabey/Mandrill Action Plan; (3) a revised Lemur Action Plan, and (4) conservation action plans for all gibbon and siamang range countries encompassing all 20 of these.
Status: On track

T-031 Prepare Best Practice Guidelines for: (1) Surveying and Monitoring Gibbons and Siamang; (2) Gibbon Ecotourism Guidelines (through the Section on Small Apes, SSA).
Status: On track

T-035 Work with zoos to support various primate species survival plans, e.g. European Association of Zoos and Aquaria Taxon Advisory Groups (EAZA TAGs) and Association of Zoos and Aquariums Species Survival Plans (AZA SSPs).
Status: On track



Subgroup of Mountain Gorilla (*Gorilla beringei beringei*) females, juveniles and infants with silverback and juvenile in the background, Democratic Republic of Congo
Photo: Russell A. Mittermeier

T-036 Improve methods by which companies measure and pay damages to great ape populations from their projects – through the Section on Great Apes (SGA) and ARRC Task Force.
Status: On track

ACT

T-014 Manage the Primate Action Fund, a small grants programme for primate conservation, monitoring, surveys, research and education.
Status: On track

T-015 Manage the Lemur Conservation Action Fund, a small grants scheme for lemur conservation, monitoring, surveys, research, and education.
Status: On track

T-022 Decrease the number of development and private sector projects in ape habitat by working with banks to incorporate information about great ape distributions and priority populations into upstream project screening (SGA-ARRC Task Force).
Status: On track

T-025 Secure sustainable funding for the ARRC (Avoid, Reduce, Restore negative impacts from energy, extractive and associated infrastructure projects on apes and contribute positively to their Conservation) Task Force's work (SGA-ARRC Task Force).
Status: On track

T-030 Increase the capacity of regional teams to monitor development and private sector project commitments to mitigate their projects' impacts on great ape populations (SGA-ARRC Task Force).
Status: On track

T-032 Provide technical guidance and status updates for small apes (gibbons and

siamang) through the APES database (SSA).
Status: On track

T-037 Fundraise for all primate conservation activities; increase funding by five times over current levels up to 2025.
Status: On track

T-038 Promote and participate in field courses for primate field research and conservation.
Status: On track

T-039 Investigate and tackle illegal primate trade, including gibbon online trade in Indonesia and Malaysia.
Status: On track

T-040 Secure funding for and develop a website of methods to improve coexistence between people and primates through the Section for Human-Primate Interactions (SHPI).
Status: On track

T-042 Provide technical guidance and status updates for great apes through the APES database and publications such as Best Practice Guidelines and Conservation Action Plans (SGA).
Status: On track

NETWORK

T-001 Continue to increase and strengthen the diversity of PSG members in terms of nationality, gender and age.
Status: On track

T-017 Add two new national/regional sections to the PSG.
Status: Achieved

T-020 Continue to organise webinars featuring research by early career primatologists.
Status: Not initiated

T-029 Stimulate and support the creation of new primatological societies in range countries.
Status: On track

T-033 Establish a Youth Section for young primatologists (ages 15–25).
Status: On track

T-034 Work to support and strengthen the Lemur Conservation Network and the Red Colobus Conservation Network.
Status: On track

T-041 Provide training in ethical human dimensions research for primatologists globally (SHPI).
Status: On track

COMMUNICATE

T-003 Stimulate primate ecotourism, i.e. primate-watching and primate life-listing, as a major conservation tool for primates.
Status: On track

T-008 Edit and publish regional newsletters/journals for the Neotropics, Africa, Asia and Madagascar: *Neotropical Primates*, *African Primates*, *Asian Primates Journal*, *Lemur News*.
Status: On track

T-009 Edit and publish the journal *Primate Conservation*.
Status: On track

T-010 Prepare and disseminate the biennial list of the 25 Most Endangered Primates in collaboration with the International Primatological Society.
Status: On track

T-011 Produce four regional field guides and four pocket guides for primates.
Status: Achieved

T-013 Promote and participate in congresses and meetings.
Status: On track

Activities and results 2024-2025

ASSESS

Communication

T-006 Maintain a taxonomic, geographic and conservation status (Red List) database for primates. (KSR 5)

Number of databases maintained: 3

Result description: As of December, 2024 the taxonomic list of primates maintained by the Primate Specialist Group (PSG) recognises 539 species and 723 taxa (species and subspecies) in 83 genera. No species or subspecies were described in 2024. Taxonomic changes have been submitted by the PSG to the Integrated Taxonomic Information System (ITIS). We have also ensured that updated taxonomic notes have been shared with the IUCN Red List unit, who have updated their databases, and made taxonomic information available via the PSG website and through a number of publications (e.g. books, field guides) published in the past year.

Red List

T-005 Complete all Red List assessments for primates and put in place a new rolling system for individual species assessments as new data become available. (KSR 6)

Number of global Red List reassessments completed: 34

Result description: As in previous years, we have continued making corrections and re-assessments where new information came to light meriting out-of-cycle updates, e.g. taxonomic changes, changes in conservation status. In 2024, we have re-assessed 34 primate taxa and corrected a further nine assessments; these assessments are with the IUCN Red List Unit and should be published in early 2025. In addition, we coordinated the response to a petition in relation to the Long-tailed Macaque (*Macaca fascicularis*), the outcome of which was that the species was deemed to be correctly assessed as Endangered but that edits needed to

be made to the assessment to improve readability by the general public. We have coordinated the update of the profile of *M. fascicularis*, which will be published in early 2025. In early 2024, we submitted the justification for the Endangered status of the Long-tailed Macaque to the IUCN Standards and Petitions Committee (SPC) following first an informal and then a formal petition from the National Association for Biomedical Research, US. In June, 2024 the SPC concluded that the species is Endangered, yet the assessments needed amendments and updating. The original assessment was published in 2022. We then submitted the reassessment to the IUCN Red List, which is awaiting response from the SPC before publishing the assessment and formally listing the species. The process was supported by Re:wild.

Research activities

T-007 Publish articles on the taxonomy, geographic distributions, surveys and conservation status of primates. (KSR 5)

Number of scientific publications about species research that acknowledge SSC affiliation: 81

Result description: The PSG edits newsletters/peer-reviewed journals to support publication of articles on primate taxonomy, ranges, surveys, and conservation status: (i) *Neotropical Primates* 2023(1) with 12 articles, and 2023(2) with three articles; (ii) *African Primates* 2023 17(1) as a special issue, 2023 17(2) with five research articles, 2024 18(1) with four research articles; (iii) *Lemur News* 2023/24 with 11 articles; (iv) *Asian Primates Journal* 2024 11(1) with four articles uploaded, yet to be published; (v) *Vietnamese Journal of Primatology* 2024 3(5) with four articles; (vi) *Primate Conservation* 2024 (37) with 15 articles and 2024 (38) with 16 articles. In 2024, the PSG also published four pocket guides, series editors: Mittermeier, RA, and Rylands, AB. Re:wild, Austin, TX, and a field guide (book), including: (1) Gatagon-Suruí, F, et al. (2024). 'Guia de

Primatas do Povo Paiter-Suruí, Guia de Identificação de Bolso'. Tropical Pocket Guide Series. Re:wild, Austin, TX, (2) Gutiérrez Pineda, KM, et al. (2024). 'Los Primates no Humanos de Panamá: Guía de Identificación de Bolsillo'. Re:wild, Austin, TX, (3) Oliveira, MA, et al. (2024). 'Primatas do Estado de Rondônia, Guia de Identificação de Bolso'. Re:wild, Austin, TX, (4) Montilha, E, et al. (2024). 'Primates do Estado de São Paulo, Guia de Identificação de Bolso'. Re:wild, Austin, TX, (5) Rylands, AB, et al. (2024). 'Illustrated Checklist of the Neotropical Primates'. Lynx Edicions, Barcelona. The *Frontiers in Conservation Science* - Special issue: Advances in the Conservation of Neotropical Primates. Eds. Karen B. Strier and Carlos Ruiz Miranda, included: (1) Ruiz-Miranda, CR, and Strier, KB. (2024). 'Editorial: Advances in the conservation of Neotropical primate'. *Front. Conserv. Sci.* 5: 1531106, (2) Rylands, AB, and Mittermeier, RA. (2024). 'Taxonomy and systematics of the Neotropical primates: a review and update'. *Front. Conserv. Sci.* 5: 1391303, (3) Oklander, LI, et al. (2024). 'Restoration of *Alouatta guariba* populations: building a binational management strategy for the conservation of the endangered brown howler monkey of the Atlantic Forest'. *Front. Conserv. Sci.* 5: 1401749, (4) López-Ramírez, L, et al. (2024). 'Perception of predation risk by tamarins and marmosets crossing bridges over a pipeline right-of-way strip in the Atlantic Forest of Brazil'. *Front. Conserv. Sci.* 5: 1473312, (5) Lagroteria, D, et al. (2024). 'Assessing the invasive potential of *Saguinus midas* in the extent of occurrence of the Critically Endangered *Saguinus bicolor*'. *Front. Conserv. Sci.* 5: 1426488, (6) Vargas, CLR, Cancharis, ZLC, and Heymann, EW. (2024). 'Characterization of forest fragments occupied by the Critically Endangered and endemic San Martín Titi Monkey (*Plecturocebus oenanthe*)'. *Front. Conserv. Sci.* 5: 1401517. And finally, one publication in *Frontiers in Genetics*:



Peruvian Yellow-tailed Woolly Monkey (*Lagothrix flavicauda*) adult male, Corosha, Department of Amazonas, Peru
Photo: Russell A. Mittermeier

Oklander, LI, *et al.* (2024). 'Phylogeography, taxonomy and conservation of the endangered brown howler monkey, *A. guariba* (Primates, Atelidae), of the Atlantic Forest'. *Front. Genet.* 15:1453005.

PLAN

Planning

T-031 Prepare Best Practice Guidelines for: (1) Surveying and Monitoring Gibbons and Siamang, (2) Gibbon Ecotourism Guidelines (through the Section on Small Apes, SSA). (KSR 8)

Number of conservation plans/strategies developed: 5

Result description: As part of the IUCN Occasional Papers series, we have the 'Best Practice Guidelines for Surveying and Monitoring Gibbon Populations' (remains *in prep.* but is now supported by an active network of 50 practitioners, the 'Best Practice Guidelines for Gibbon Rehabilitation and Rewilding', which is an update of the 2015 version, the 'Best Practice Guidelines for Gibbon Translocation', also an update of the 2015 version, the 'Best Practice Guidelines for Gibbon Health and Disease Monitoring, the 'Best Practice Guidelines for the Stewardship of Primates in Fragments', an IUCN publication by Marsh, LK, Carretero-Piñón, X, Boonratana, *et al.* (*in prep.*).

T-035 Work with zoos to support various primate species survival plans, e.g. European Association of Zoos and Aquaria Taxon Advisory Groups (EAZA TAGs) and Association of Zoos and Aquariums Species Survival Plans (AZA SSPs). (KSR 8)

Number of conservation plans/strategies developed: 7

Result description: The SSA established rewilding and *in situ* Gibbon conservation guidelines for the EAZA Gibbon TAG, also established the Gibbon SAFE programme with AZA SSP. The SSA held the 5th Gibbon Husbandry and Conservation Conference in October, 2024 in Malaysia to bring together gibbon conservationists working in zoos, rescue centres and with wild

populations. In 2024, taxonomic advice was provided to the EAZA Callitrichid TAG, and to the AZA SSP (related to Atelidae). K.A.I Nekar is taxon advisor for the nocturnal prosimians held in EAZA collections. Working with zoos to develop conservation programmes and breeding plans for nocturnal prosimians, including using 'non-threatened' species as ambassadors for those threatened in the wild. In Madagascar, the Lemur Conservation Network now counts numerous zoos among its 65 member organisations. Furthermore, Drew Cronin (Noth Carolina Zoo) and Noah Dunham (Cleveland Metroparks Zoo) were instrumental in finalising the creation of a colobus AZA SAFE programme, which will encourage the American zoo community to support red colobus research and conservation activities.

Policy

T-028 Prepare action plans for the conservation of primate species and species groups, including: (1) the Red Colobus Action Plan, (2) the Mangabey/Mandrill Action Plan, (3) a revised Lemur Action Plan, (4) conservation action plans for all gibbon and siamang range countries encompassing all 20. (KSR 9)

Number of policies where SSC members provided technical input: 4

Result description: In 2024, the following action plans were published: (1) Ang, A, *et al.* (2024). 'Asian Langurs (*Presbytis*) Conservation Action Plan 2024–2034'. IUCN, Gland, Switzerland, (2) Dempsey, A, *et al.* (2024). '*Cercocebus* and *Mandrillus* spp. Conservation Action Plan 2023–2027'. IUCN SSC Primate Specialist Group. IUCN. Gland, Switzerland. In addition, the following Conservation Action Plans are in preparation: (1) 'Conservation Action Plan for the Mesoamerican Primates', (2) 'Conservation Action Plan for the Neotropical Ateline Primates: Spider monkeys (*Ateles*) and Woolly Monkeys (*Lagothrix*)'.

T-036 Improve methods by which companies measure and pay damages to great ape populations from their projects (through the Section on Great Apes [SGA] and ARRC Task Force). (KSR 9)

Number of policies where SSC members provided technical input: 0

Result description: The ARRC Task Force has continued to provide advice to projects and has now been contacted by ca. 40 projects potentially impacting great apes. More projects are aware of the existence of the ARRC Task Force, but there is also more pressure from lenders to contact us. The ARRC Task Force has helped to collect more robust baseline data which is the basis on which a project can then apply the mitigation hierarchy – avoid first, then minimize, restore and compensate. The ARRC Task Force has also helped develop stronger and more exhaustive mitigation measures for projects through the combined feedback from independent panels it organises which include primatologists from ape range countries. The ARRC Task Force also produces a [pamphlet](#) that companies can use to reduce the risk of disease transmission from humans to apes, and vice-versa.

ACT

Conservation actions

T-014 Manage the Primate Action Fund, a small grants programme for primate conservation, monitoring, surveys, research and education. (KSR 10)

Number of threatened species benefiting from *in situ* conservation action: 83

Result description: Re:wild - Margot Marsh Biodiversity Foundation Primate Action Fund (Africa, Asia) with 32 grants awarded during the funding cycle of March, 2023 to March, 2024 totalling US\$148,540. Additionally, 43 Re:wild Neotropical Primate Action Fund grants were awarded during the funding cycle of July, 2023 to June, 2024, totalling US\$496,097; 12 Gustavo Fonseca Fund grants for African primates were awarded, totalling US\$100,000; 30

Re:wild Lemur Action Fund grants were awarded during the funding cycle of July, 2023 to June, 2024, totalling US\$390,969; three SOS SSC Lemur Research Action Fund grants were awarded, totalling during the period June 10- December 10, 2024 totalling US\$9,794.83; 14 Mohammed bin Zayed Species Conservation Fund grants for primates were awarded, totalling US\$17,500; and 20 Margot Marsh Biodiversity Foundation grants were awarded, totalling US\$516,700.

T-015 Manage the Lemur Conservation Action Fund, a small grants scheme for lemur conservation, monitoring, surveys, research, and education. (KSR 10)

Number of threatened species benefiting from *in situ* conservation action: 32

Result description: Three SOS SSC Lemur Research Action Fund grants were awarded, totalling US\$9,794.83 during the period June 10- December 10, 2024 and 30 Lemur Conservation Action Fund grants were awarded totalling US\$390,969 during the funding cycle of July 2023-June, 2024.

T-022 Decrease the number of development and private sector projects in ape habitat by working with banks to incorporate information about great ape distributions and priority populations into upstream project screening (SGA-ARRC Task Force). (KSR 10)

Number of development and private sector projects contacted: 0

Result description: The ARRC Task Force has maintained and developed further relationships with lending institutions with the aim of increasing their awareness of the ARRC Task Force and to facilitate the sharing of information for better avoidance of ape habitat upstream. The ARRC Task Force continues to increase the number of requests it received, either for engagement and/or for general questions on great apes from the private sector, which is a good sign that more projects are trying to follow best practice. The International Finance Corporation is also reducing the number of projects it finances in ape habitat.

T-030 Increase the capacity of regional teams to monitor development and private sector project commitments to mitigate their project's impacts on great ape populations (SGA-ARRC Task Force). (KSR 10)

Number of regional teams trained: 6

Result description: The ARRC Task Force completed its Primate WATCH programme in Central Africa with the financial support of GEF through UNEP-GRASP. Eight primatologists from Gabon, Cameroon, Republic of Congo and Democratic Republic of the Congo were trained on how to improve the mitigation of impacts from large-scale development projects on apes. Two workshops took place in Gabon and Cameroon where participants could see first-hand the impacts of hydroelectric dams, road rehabilitation, onshore oil extraction and agribusiness, and discuss with companies on how they are mitigating these impacts on great apes. Another workshop was held in September, 2024 which brought together participants of the West African iteration of the Primate WATCH programme with the one of the Central Africa iterations. The [Primate WATCH network](#) was launched to facilitate exchange of knowledge, experience and information between all participants, and continue the mission to improve the mitigation of impacts on apes. The ARRC Task Force also organised a training in Guinea for 23 people from mining companies that are part of the 'Réseau Environnement Bauxite'. This training was aimed specifically at promoting best practice in mining with regards to the mitigation of their impacts on chimpanzees. It was also aimed at ensuring better alignment in mitigation measures and monitoring, including the sharing of data, between these mining companies that operate in the same landscape.

T-037 Fundraise for all primate conservation activities; increase funding by five times over current levels up to 2025. (KSR 10)

Amount of funds raised: US\$6,208,734

Result description: Total US\$6,208,734 raised from 10 donors and agencies.

T-038 Promote and participate in field courses for primate field research and conservation. (KSR 10)

Field courses supported or participated in: Ongoing.

Result description: In 2024 we supported a training course of primatological methods to study and conserve the Coiba Island Howler Monkey (*Alouatta coibensis coibensis*) at Coiba Island National Park, Veraguas, Republic of Panama. We also supported 'Educating for Conservation: Empowering Stakeholders' in Costa Rica through a training programme on the natural history of the Black-crowned Central American Squirrel Monkey (*Saimiri oerstedii*), one of the 25 Most Endangered Primates of the World. And, the section for Nocturnal Prosimians organised an international online training 'Unveiling the Unseen' with over 300 participants, learning about bioacoustics methods, radio tracking, accelerometers, appropriate use of lighting and other methods.

T-039 Investigate and tackle illegal primate trade, including gibbon online trade in Indonesia and Malaysia. (KSR 10)

Number of actions addressing major drivers/emerging threats of species or population loss: 10

Result description: In 2024, the Section on Small Apes (SSA) continued working with colleagues and rescue centres in Malaysia and Indonesia to tackle illegal trade of gibbons in these countries, with additional funding from Synchronicity Earth. The SSA also continue to arrange International Gibbon Day events which in 2024 had a reach of 135,000, and has expanded social media presence – now on Instagram, managed by a part-time social media manager. The SSA is developing interactive maps and campaign materials for tackling online trade and posters for adaptation by projects to meet their own needs using SSA branding. Moreover, the SSA website now has a translate function to



Western Red Colobus
(*Piliocolobus badius temminckii*),
Abuko Nature Reserve, The Gambia
Photo: Russell A. Mittermeier

help non-English speakers access the information on this site. The SSA supported the attendance at 3 international conferences for 29 gibbon conservationists, and has provided support for vets/rescue centers. A long-term strategy for tackling online trade in gibbons is underway in collaboration with International Animal Rescue Indonesia and Gibbonesia with support from Synchronicity Earth. The SSA collaborated with the SHPI to produce the Guidelines for tourists and for tourism providers about responsible primate watching published including sections on the small apes. And we published in *Primate Conservation*: Chavez, J, and Nijman, V. (2024). 'The Open Sale of Primate Skulls on Bali Reveal Complex Indonesia-wide Wildlife Trade Networks'. *Primate Conservation* 38: 174-184.

T-040 Secure funding for and develop a website of methods to improve coexistence between people and primates through the Section for Human-Primate Interactions (SHPI). (KSR 10)

Number of threatened species benefiting from *in-situ* conservation action: 10

Result description: The Section on Human-Primate Interactions (SHPI) revised and published its mission statement. We organised a webinar about conducting human conservation behaviour change for IUCN members which is available to view on our website. We published a [webpage](#) of resources regarding ethics and inclusion to provide information for primate conservationists who wish to conduct social science research. The [IUCN SSC Primate Specialist Group Position Statement Regarding Primates in Agroecosystems v.2](#) was published, as well as, the [IUCN SSC Primate Specialist Group Position Statement on Primate Consumption for Wild Meat and Terminology](#) (published in February, 2025). A [Position Statement Regarding the Capture of Wild Primates for Biomedical and Pharmaceutical Research](#) was also published, and 'Why Primates Make Bad Pets' by Waters, S, et al.



Guianan Black Spider Monkey (*Ateles paniscus*),
Vulnerable, Voltzberg area, Central Suriname Nature
Reserve, Suriname
Photo: Russell A. Mittermeier

T-042 Provide technical guidance and status updates for great apes through the APES database and publications such as Best Practice Guidelines and Conservation Action Plans (SGA). (KSR 10)

Technical guidance and status updates for great apes through the APES database and publications given: Ongoing.

Result description: The APES database continues to provide great ape researchers with data to analyse different aspects of great ape density and distribution among other research questions.

NETWORK

Capacity building

T-029 Stimulate and support the creation of new primatological societies in range countries. (KSR 2)

Number of people trained in conservation planning: 0

Result description: In 2024, support was given to a budding Paraguayan Primate Society. The draft Constitution and By-Laws for the proposed Asian Primatological Association was prepared by Ramesh Boonratana.

T-041 Provide training in ethical human dimensions research for primatologists globally (SHPI). (KSR 2)

Number of training courses delivered: 0

Result description: In 2024 and 2025, the following was prepared: (1) Kirsten V. Gilardi, Ariane D  x, Thomas R. Gillespie, Gladys Kalema-Zikusoka, Fabian Leendertz, Chim  ne Nze-Nkogue, Livia V. Patrono, Jane Raphael, Fransiska Sulisty, Eddy Kambale Syaluha and Chris Whittier. 'An update on great ape population health, disease control and outbreak response'. Supplement to the Best Practice Guidelines for Health Monitoring and Disease Control in Great Ape Populations. Edited by Jacqueline L. Sunderland-Groves, Elizabeth A. Williamson and Elizabeth J. Macfie. Approved by the IUCN Editorial Board. Current status: in design and layout; (2) SSC Primate Specialist Group, Section on Great Apes. 2025. 'Best Practice

Guidelines for Orangutan Wild-to-Wild Translocation'. Current status: in design and layout; (3) Hjalmar Kühl, Samantha Strindberg, Serge Wich, Marc Ancrenaz, Fiona Maisels, Mimi Arandjelovic, Anne-Sophie Cruncheon, Noémi Cappelle, Tenekwetché Sop and Isabel Ordaz Németh. (2025). 'Best Practice Guidelines for Surveys and Monitoring of Great Ape Populations'. 2nd edition. Edited by Jacqueline Sunderland-Groves. Current status: from February to March, 2025 IUCN external peer review.

Membership

T-001 Continue to increase and strengthen the diversity of PSG members in terms of nationality, gender and age. (KSR 2)

Number of SSC members recruited: 5

Result description: Currently, the IUCN SSC Primate Specialist Group (PSG) has approximately 800 members. Membership for the PSG was reconstituted for the 2021-2025 time period through a process that concluded in September, 2022. As such, the number of SSC members recruited in 2024 was likely ca. five people, in addition to those recruited earlier in the reconstitution cycle. The structure of the SG Executive Committee is currently as follows: Chair (one person); Deputy Chairs (five people); Foundation Liaison Officer (one); Executive Secretariat (two); Vice Chairs, Section on Great Apes (six); Vice Chairs, Section on Small Apes (three); Vice Chairs, Section on Human-Primate Interactions (one); Section on African and Asian Nocturnal Prosimians (one) Regional Vice Chairs – Neotropics, Mesoamerica (two), Northern Andean Countries (six), Brazil and the Guianas (seven), Southern Cone (one); Regional Vice Chairs – Africa (five); Regional Vice Chairs – Madagascar (three); Regional Vice Chairs – Asia, China (one); East and South East Asia (nine), South Asia (two), Red List Authorities (three). A new section of the Neotropical region for Venezuela and the Guianas is proposed for the next quadrennium. A Section on African and Asian Nocturnal Prosimians was formalised in

2024, with K. Anne Isola Nekaris as chair. Thirteen members of the PSG agreed to join the subgroup for African and Asian Nocturnal Prosimians, 12 non-members also expressed their interest, and will be members of this subsection. At the moment the Asian lorises have a more active community working on their research and conservation, and Nekaris has established a biweekly meeting with this young generation of researchers via Google Meet and Whatsapp (currently 31 members including from Uganda, Bangladesh, Thailand, India, China, Malaysia, Indonesia, Philippines). These meetings assist young researchers to conduct research on nocturnal prosimians; analyse their data; publish their findings; and help them in grant writing and conference presentations. Exchanges are also made on appropriate field methods. The group also includes several key academics and conservationists working on nocturnal primates to act as mentors to the students. On the May 17, 2024, the subgroup held an online conference for Reverse the Red on nocturnal primate study methods. This featured a number of major equipment providers for nocturnal studies giving tips on how to use the equipment. As part of the Slow and Slender Loris Outreach Week which has occurred every year in September since 2011, the theme was captive management of nocturnal prosimians and zoos and rescue centres around the world participated. This also gave a chance to distribute the newly published Lorisid Husbandry Manual. In 2025, this outreach week will be extended to the galagos and tarsiers where possible with the 2025 theme being Taxonomy and its importance for conservation. Short notes and communications on lorises were edited and published in the PSG's *Asian Primates Journal*.

T-033 Establish a Youth Section for young primatologists (ages 15–25). (KSR 2)

Number of SSC members recruited: 5

Result description: A 'youth section' has been established led by Hugo Leroy.

Synergy

T-034 Work to support and strengthen the Lemur Conservation Network (LCN) and the Red Colobus Conservation Network. (KSR 1)

Number of 'in kind' partnerships established and maintained: 2

Result description: The [Lemur Conservation Network](#) (LCN) is a project of the Madagascar Section of the IUCN SSC Primate Specialist Group. It unites over 60 organisations with the many individuals, zoos, and partners that are working to save lemurs from extinction. raise awareness, link funding with conservation programmes and provide a forum for NGOs, researchers, corporations and the public to enhance communication and coordination. In 2024, the LCN achieved many goals spanning education, professional development for Malagasy professionals, and worldwide engagement in lemur conservation. In Education: sponsored four schools near protected areas in eastern Madagascar through Teach for Madagascar, training 26 teachers and providing educational materials for 710 students. Provided our Malagasy language Lemurs card game for use in over 50 schools in Madagascar through partnerships with Teach for Madagascar and members of LCN. On Professional Development and Support for Malagasy Professionals: grew our Malagasy Student and Professional Membership to 22 individuals, 11 of whom completed paid science communications work for LCN. Awarded two small grants to Malagasy professionals: one is starting a new conservation initiative in Antahala; one held a World Lemur Festival event in Toamasina which involved 500 students, 28 artists, and five local associations in the celebration of lemurs. Donated to four Malagasy-led conservation organisations. For Worldwide Engagement in Lemur Conservation: at least 35 zoos participated in 2024 World Lemur Day, including at least 12 who participated for the first time. Provided our English language Lemurs card game to 27 zoos and 20 individuals

in 2024, increasing our total distribution of the English games to 50 zoos and 33 individuals. Gained 28 Supporting Members whose membership fees support our education work in Madagascar and Malagasy-led conservation projects. These Supporting Members include 10 businesses, 15 individuals, and three conservation organisations. Engaged 10 international volunteers who participated in science communications, education, and zoo engagement. In terms of Online Engagement: the English website received about 150,000 views, and the Malagasy website about 20,000 views. The LCN's Facebook achieved a reach of approximately 850,000 and 380,000 views; 53% of our Facebook audience is in Madagascar. Instagram achieved a reach of approximately 80,000 and 130,000 views; 9% of our Instagram audience is in Madagascar. Red Colobus Conservation Network (RCCN) is a community of volunteer's individuals, government institutions, academic institutions, zoos, local, national and international conservation organisations and other interested parties dedicated to improving the conservation status of Red Colobus and raising the global profile of these highly endangered primate species. It currently has 323 members and more than 16 partners. More than 45 projects were supported through the Margot Marsh Biodiversity Foundation, Re:wild's Primate Action Fund (PAF), Milkywire, the Mohamed bin Zayed Conservation Fund, and others. Eleven articles were published. Five training courses were offered. Six national and international conferences (APS, CPS, ICCB, ICBC, others) were attended to raise awareness on red colobus conservation initiatives and activities. Red colobus training, awareness and education materials were produced ([available at the RCCN website](#)). The RCCN is now a member of the African Civil Society Biodiversity Alliance (ACBA) platform, and red colobus are included in the AZA SAFE (Saving Animals from Extinction) programme, which focuses

the collective expertise in AZA-accredited zoos and aquariums, and leverages their massive audiences to save species. Plans for 2025 include: the creation of red colobus subgroups in the RCCN, contributions to members' capacity building and experience through training courses, workshops, and fieldwork, support for members' projects, the improvement of communication between members and for members' activities and projects, review of projects prior to submission and during selection, the organisation of workshops at the International Primatological Congress in Madagascar (2025) and other national and international gatherings, and the development partnerships with other organisations, institutions, and zoos.

Red colobus projects were well represented at the 2024 African Primatological Society conference in South Africa. There is an increase in red colobus-focused research and conservation activities being presented at conferences, showing the many ways in which researchers and conservation practitioners are addressing the priority actions identified in the Red Colobus Conservation Action Plan. In 2024, with funding from Re:wild, Josh Linder, through The Forest Collective helped to support the conservation education needs of red colobus priority sites (including Bioko, Tana River, The Gambia, and eastern DRC).

COMMUNICATE Communication

T-003 Stimulate primate ecotourism, i.e. primate-watching and primate life-listing, as a major conservation tool for primates. (KSR 13)

Number of print communications materials distributed in relation to specific taxonomic groups: 8

Result description: Further distribution and awareness campaign for the [Small Ape Field Guide](#). Work underway in collaboration with Global Gibbon Network to create an accreditation system for small ape tourism. Pursue documentation of gibbon myths and legends from the habitat countries as

part of the work to link conservation and culture as well as document these myths before they are lost. From June to July, 2024 we assessed and mapped out the tourism assets along the Nakawan Range (P. Malaysia) and provided guidelines for an integrated sustainable tourism development strategy. The Nakawan Range hosts the only known population of *Macaca arctoides* in Malaysia. In September, 2024 we assisted and trained the Kampung Bolotikon community (Bornean Malaysia) to map out the ecotourism assets in the community forests. Also provided training in asset interpretation and product development. From September, 2023 to February, 2025 we distributed pocket identification guides of Malaysia and Thailand via postal services or in-person during travels, lectures, and workshops.

T-008 Edit and publish regional newsletters/journals for the Neotropics, Africa, Asia and Madagascar: *Neotropical Primates*, *African Primates*, *Asian Primates Journal*, *Lemur News*. (KSR 12)

Number of Species e-bulletin, Save Our Species newsletter, SSC Groups' newsletter editions produced: 4

Result description: In 2024, we published *African Primates* 2024 18 with four research articles, *Lemur News* 2023/24 with 11 articles, *Asian Primates Journal* 2024 11(one) with four articles uploaded, yet to be published, and *Vietnamese Journal of Primatology* 2024 3(5) with four articles.

T-009 Edit and publish the journal *Primate Conservation*. (KSR 12)

Number of Species e-bulletin, Save Our Species newsletter, SSC Groups' newsletter editions produced: 2

Result description: In 2024, we published the *Primate Conservation* 2024 (37) with 15 articles, and *Primate Conservation* 2024 (38) with 16 articles.

T-010 Prepare and disseminate the biennial list of the 25 Most Endangered Primates in collaboration with the International Primatological Society. (KSR 13)

Muriqui (*Brachyteles hypoxanthus*), Fazenda Montes Claros, Caratinga, Minas Gerais, Brazil
Photo: R.A. Mittermeier



Juvenile Pygmy Slow Loris
(*Xanthonycticebus pygmaeus*),
Ban Konglor village, Laos
Photo: Russell A. Mittermeier

Number of print communications materials distributed in relation to specific taxonomic groups: 1

Result description: We published: Mittermeier, RA, et al. (eds.). (2024). 'Primates in Peril: The World's 25 Most Endangered Primates 2023–2025'. IUCN SSC Primate Specialist Group (PSG), International Primatological Society (IPS) and Re:wild, Austin, TX, US. 154pp. ISBN 979-8-218-44952-0.

T-011 Produce four regional field guides and four pocket guides for primates. (KSR 13)

Number of print communications materials distributed in relation to specific taxonomic groups: 6

Result description: In 2024, we produced the following Pocket Guides: (1) Gatagon-Suruí, F, et al. (2024). 'Guia de Primatas do Povo Paiter-Suruí, Guia de Identificação de Bolso'. Tropical Pocket Guide Series, Series editors: Mittermeier, RA, and Rylands, AB. Re:wild, Austin, TX; (2) Gutiérrez Pineda, KM, et al. (2024). 'Los Primates no Humanos de Panamá, Guía de Identificación de Bolsillo'. Series editors: Mittermeier, RA, and Rylands, AB. Re:wild, Austin, TX; (3) Oliveira, MA, et al. (2024). 'Primatas do Estado de Rondônia, Guia de Identificação de Bolso'. Series editors: Mittermeier, RA, and Rylands, AB. Re:wild, Austin, TX; (4) Montilha, E, et al. (2024). 'Primates do Estado de São Paulo, Guia de Identificação de Bolso'. Series editors:

Mittermeier, RA, and Rylands, AB. Re:wild, Austin, TX. As well as, Regional Field Guides: (1) Rylands, AB, et al. (2024). 'Illustrated Checklist of the Neotropical Primates'. Lynx Edicions, Barcelona. 141 pp; (2) 'Illustrated Checklist of the Asian Primates'. Lynx Edicions, Barcelona. In prep; (3) 'Illustrated Checklist of the African Primates'. Lynx Edicions, Barcelona. In preparation; and (4) 'Neotropical Primates Field Guide'. In preparation.

T-013 Promote and participate in congresses and meetings. (KSR 13)

Number of SSC members' presentations developed in relation to specific taxonomic groups: 15

Result description: In 2024 and 2025, we participated in the following congresses and meetings: (1) XX Congress of the Brazilian Primatological Society, Santa Teresa, Espírito Santo, Brazil, July 7-12, 2024. Hosted by the Instituto Nacional da Mata Atlântica (INMA).; (2) 5th Latin American and 4th Colombian Primatological Congress: 'Strengthening Latin American Primatological, Research', Universidad Tecnológica de Pereira (UTP), Pereira, Risaralda, Colombia, November 25-29, 2024; (3) XXX Congress of the International Primatological Society, Antananarivo Madagascar. August 10-15, 2025. Considerable financial support provided for the logistics and attendance (travel grants) has been provided; (4) Thai Gibbon Action Plan Workshop, Sai Yok, Thailand, 6-7 February, 2025; (5) Ramesh Boonratana

delivered a series of one-day Workshops on Competency Development for Biodiversity Conservation, and lectures on 'Ecosystem Resilience & Sustainable Conservation Strategies: Nurturing Biodiversity in Northeast India', to eight colleges and Gauhati University's Department of Zoology over 15 days in March, 2024; (6) 9th Asian Primates Symposium in Medan, November 23-27, 2024, and (7) 3rd African Primatological Society Conference, Potchefstroom, South Africa, September 25-28, 2024.

Summary of achievements

Total number of targets 2021–2025: 31

Geographic regions: 27 Global, 4 Africa, 1 Asia

Actions during 2024-2025:

Assess: 3 (KSR 5, 6)

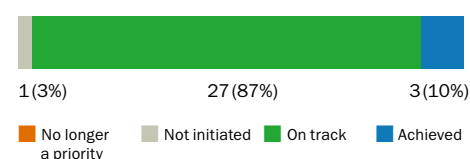
Plan: 4 (KSR 8, 9)

Act: 9 (KSR 10)

Network: 5 (KSR 1, 2)

Communicate: 6 (KSR 12, 13)

Overall achievement 2021–2025:



Legend: No longer a priority (orange), Not initiated (grey), On track (green), Achieved (blue)

Suweon Treefrog
(*Dryophytes suweonensis*)
Photo: Amael Borzee



Marsh Cinquefoil
(*Comarum palustre*)
Photo: Magnus Goransson



Phallus aureolatus
Photo: Juliano Baltazar



Eurasian Griffon (*Gyps fulvus*)
Photo: Andre Botha



Black Rhino (*Diceros bicornis*)
Photo: Save The Rhino Trust Namibia



Azores Nursery Spider
(*Pisaura acoreensis*)
Photo: Paulo A.V. Borges



Black and White Snapper
(*Macolor niger*)
Photo: David B. Snyder